

5.5 Connectivity

5.5.1 Bluetooth

A short-range (10 m-100 m) wireless connectivity standard used to connect a wide variety of devices like music players, mobile phones, digital cameras, and laptops over a secure network. It consumes low power and transfers data at rates of 1-3 Megabits per second. The latest Bluetooth version is v2.1, while the faster v3.0 is in the works.

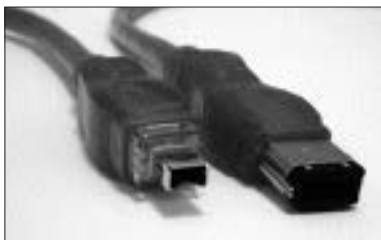


A Bluetooth headphone set

Bluetooth works without user intervention—a Bluetooth-enabled device continuously sends out very low powered signals, and upon receiving a response from another compatible device, starts an auto identification process, which culminates in the transfer of data. Bluetooth is suitable for personal area networks (within a radius of about 10 metres) for controlling several devices seamlessly.

5.5.2 FireWire

A high-speed interface, whose development was initiated by Apple. It is also known as IEEE 1394 High Speed Serial Bus. It was meant to be a replacement for the parallel SCSI bus, and also to provide connectivity to audio and video equipment. Camcorders, memory



FireWire connectors

and storage devices, professional audio systems, etc. come with FireWire interfaces, as do several laptops. The data transfer rates over FireWire interfaces at 400 Mbps is comparable to that of USB 2.0, but unlike USB 2.0, the data flow rates can be sustained over a longer period of time. However, FireWire is more expensive because of licensing issues, and so is not as common as USB.